M14 Ethyl Chloride (Chloroethane)

Scope of Practice	EMR
Classification	• Topical Anesthetic
Usual Presentation	• 100ml Chloroethane without propellant bottle
Mechanism of Action	• Chloroethane evaporates rapidly, cooling the skin surface, which temporarily desensitizes nerve endings by slowing their ability to transmit pain signals. • May dissolve into nerve membranes, interfering with voltage-gated sodium channels preventing nerve depolarization and blocking pain signals.
Indications	• Topical anesthesia associated with minor contusions, sprains or IV cannulation.
Contraindications	• Hypersensitivity to ethyl chloride products
Precautions	• Nil
Side Effects	• Changes in skin pigmentation • Frosting of the skin causing tissue necrosis
Adult Dose & Administration	• Topically apply for 3-7 seconds from distance of 3-9 inches until just before skin begins to turn white
Pediatric Dose & Administration	• Topically apply for 3-7 seconds from distance of 3-9 inches until just before skin begins to turn white
Use in Pregnancy and Lactation	• Pregnancy: Safety has not been established. Crossing the placenta is unlikely. • Lactation: Safety has not been established.
Additional Information	• Nil